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JEFFERSON DAVIS PARISH
POLICE JURY

DISTRICT 1 Donald Woods
DISTRICT 2 Chad Woods
DISTRICT 3 Marcus Peterson
DISTRICT 4 Kori Meyers
DISTRICT 5 Tim McKnight
DISTRICT 6 Melvin Adams
DISTRICT 7 Steve Eastman President
DISTRICT 8 Wayne Fruge
DISTRICT 9 David LeJeune
DISTRICT 10 Byron Buller
DISTRICT 11 Butch Lafargue Vice President
DISTRICT 12 Owen Cormier
DISTRICT 13 Bill Labouve

10/01/2025

The Honorable Jeff Landry
Governor of Louisiana
P.O. Box 94004
Baton Rouge, LA 70804

Re: Local Oversight of Class VI Carbon Sequestration Injection Wells in Jefferson Davis Parish

Dear Governor Landry,

On behalf of the Jefferson Davis Parish Police Jury, I write to express deep concern regarding the emerging practice of carbon capture and storage (CCS), specifically the injection of carbon dioxide into deep geologic formations beneath our parish. While this technology is being promoted as a tool to reduce atmospheric carbon emissions and as a potential economic opportunity, its long-term risks and consequences for Louisiana communities, particularly those in southwest Louisiana, remain uncertain.

Jefferson Davis Parish, like many of our neighbors, relies entirely on the Chicot Aquifer for drinking water. This aquifer is the sole source of potable water for our residents and a vital resource for our agricultural economy. It sustains thousands of acres of rice and crawfish farmland, provides water to local municipalities, and underpins nearly every aspect of daily life in our region. Any threat to its quality or stability is, by definition, a threat to the future of our parish.

The injection of CO_2 beneath this aquifer, a process still new to Louisiana and largely untested in our unique hydrogeologic conditions, raises significant concerns. Questions remain about the long-term behavior and mobility of CO_2 underground, including whether it can remain securely contained for the decades or centuries intended.

While we recognize the interest of the state and industry in advancing carbon management technologies, it is the residents and local governments who will bear the consequences if something goes wrong. Jefferson Davis Parish does not have the financial or technical capacity to respond to a major contamination event, nor can our communities simply relocate should our only source of drinking water become compromised.

For these reasons, and with the health, safety, and future of our people at stake, we respectfully request that local governments, specifically Jefferson Davis Parish, be granted clear authority to approve or deny Class VI CO_2 injection wells within their jurisdictions. Local oversight would ensure that those most directly affected, and most invested in the long-term well-being of our

communities, have a meaningful role before irreversible decisions are made.

We believe that empowering parishes to participate directly in the permitting process is a commonsense, precautionary step. It reflects Louisiana's tradition of strong local governance and ensures that economic development does not come at the expense of public health, water security, or generational stewardship of our natural resources.

Thank you for your leadership and for considering this vital request. We stand ready to work with you, our legislative delegation, and state agencies to develop a framework that both supports innovation and protects the people and resources of Jefferson Davis Parish.

Respectfully,

J. Steven Eastman
Parish President
Jefferson Davis Parish Police Jury

CC:
The Honorable Troy Romero, Louisiana House of Representatives
The Honorable Mark Abraham, Louisiana State Senate